



File No.: EXP202305730

RESOLUTION OF RIGHTS PROCEDURE

Having carried out the procedural actions provided for in Title VIII of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and the Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter LOPDGDD), the following FACTS have been established:

FIRST: The complainant exercised the right of Erasure against the respondent, and their request, as stated by the complainant, did not receive the legally established response.

The complainant provides various documents related to the complaint filed with this Agency and regarding the exercise of the right exercised.

SECOND: Once the procedure established in Article 65.4 of the LOPDGDD was fulfilled, the complaint was admitted for processing, and the respondent entity was granted a hearing period, to present the arguments it deemed appropriate within ten working days.

The respondent entity has not demonstrated, during the formalized procedures, that it has responded to the request for the exercise of rights presented by the complainant.

LEGAL GROUNDS

I

Competence

In accordance with the powers granted to each supervisory authority by Article 58.2 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 (General Data Protection Regulation, hereinafter GDPR), and as established in Articles 47, 48.1, and 64.1 of Organic Law 3/2018, of December 5, on the Protection of Personal Data and the Guarantee of Digital Rights (hereinafter LOPDGDD), the Director of the Spanish Data Protection Agency is competent to initiate and resolve this procedure.

Furthermore, Article 63.2 of the LOPDGDD states that: "The procedures processed by the Spanish Data Protection Agency shall be governed by the provisions of Regulation (EU) 2016/679, by this organic law, by the regulatory provisions issued for its development, and, in so far as they do not contradict them, subsidiarily by the general rules on administrative procedures."

II

Preliminary Issues

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In accordance with the provisions of Article 55 of the GDPR, the Spanish Data Protection Agency is competent to perform the functions assigned to it in Article 57, including the enforcement of the Regulation and promoting awareness among controllers and processors regarding their obligations, as well as addressing complaints filed by a data subject and investigating, as appropriate, the reasons for them.

Correspondingly, Article 31 of the GDPR establishes the obligation of controllers and processors to cooperate with the supervisory authority that requests it in the performance of its functions. In cases where they have appointed a data protection officer, Article 39 of the GDPR assigns this officer the function of cooperating with that authority.

In accordance with this regulation, following the procedure established in Article 65.4 of the LOPDGDD, prior to the admission of the complaint regarding the exercise of the rights regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR, which gives rise to this procedure, the complaint was forwarded to the respondent for analysis, to respond to this Agency within one month and to demonstrate that it had provided the complainant with the appropriate response.

The result of this forwarding did not allow for the understanding that the complainant's requests were satisfied. Consequently, on June 15, 2023, for the purposes provided for in Articles 64.1 and 65 of the LOPDGDD, the complaint was admitted for processing. This admission for processing determines the

opening of the present procedure for the lack of attention to a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR, regulated in Article 64.1 of the LOPDGDD, which states: "When the procedure refers exclusively to the lack of attention to a request for the exercise of the rights established in Articles 15 to 22 of Regulation (EU) 2016/679 of the European Parliament and of the Council, of April 27, 2016, it shall be initiated by an admission agreement, which shall be adopted in accordance with the provisions of Article 65 of this organic law.

In this case, the time limit for resolving the procedure shall be six months from the date on which the admission agreement was notified to the complainant. Upon expiration of this period, the interested party may consider their complaint accepted."

Article 58.2 of the GDPR grants the Spanish Data Protection Agency a series of corrective powers to correct any infringement of the GDPR, including "ordering the controller or processor to respond to requests for the exercise of the rights of the data subject under this Regulation."

III

Rights of Individuals in the Area of Personal Data Protection

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The rights of individuals regarding the protection of personal data are regulated in Articles 15 to 22 of the GDPR and Articles 13 to 18 of the LOPDGDD. The rights of access, rectification, erasure, objection, the right to restriction of processing, and the right to data portability are contemplated. The formal aspects related to the exercise of these rights are established in Articles 12 of the GDPR and 12 of the LOPDGDD.

Additionally, the provisions expressed in Recitals 59 and following of the GDPR are taken into account. In accordance with the provisions of these regulations, the data controller must establish formulas and mechanisms to facilitate the exercise of rights by the data subject, which shall be free of charge (without prejudice to the provisions of Articles 12.5 and 15.3 of the GDPR), and is obliged to respond to requests made no later than one month, unless it can demonstrate that it is unable to identify the data subject, and must express its reasons in case it does not intend to comply with such request. The burden of proof regarding compliance with the obligation to respond to the request for the exercise of rights made by the affected party lies with the data controller.

The communication directed to the data subject regarding their request must be expressed in a concise, transparent, intelligible, and easily accessible manner, using clear and simple language.

Regarding the right of access to personal data, in accordance with the provisions of Article 13 of the LOPDGDD, when the exercise of the right refers to a large amount of data, the data controller may request the affected party to specify the "data or processing activities to which the request refers." The right shall be deemed granted if the data controller provides remote access to the data, considering the request fulfilled (although the data subject may request the information referred to in the aspects provided in Article 15 of the GDPR).

The exercise of this right may be considered repetitive on more than one occasion during a period of six months, unless there is legitimate cause for it.

On the other hand, the request will be considered excessive when the affected party chooses a means other than the one offered that entails a disproportionate cost, which must be borne by the affected party.

IV

Conclusion

In the case analyzed here, the claiming party exercised their right of Erasure regulated in Article 17 of the GDPR and Article 15 of the LOPDGDD.

After the period established in accordance with the aforementioned regulations, their request did not receive the legally required response. The entity being claimed has not attended to the request of the claiming party nor to the requirements that have been sent to it by this Agency.

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The aforementioned regulations do not allow for the request to be disregarded as if it had not been made, leaving it without the response that the responsible parties are obligated to issue, even in the event that there are no data of the interested party in the entity's files or even in those cases where the requirements set forth are not met, in which case the recipient of such request is also obliged to require the correction of the observed deficiencies or, if applicable, to deny the request with justification indicating the reasons why the right in question cannot be considered.

Therefore, the request made obliges the responsible party to provide an express response, in any case, using any means that justifies the receipt of the response.

Given that a copy of the necessary communication that must be directed to the claimant informing them of the decision made regarding the exercise of rights request has not been provided, it is appropriate to uphold the complaint that originated this procedure.

Considering the cited provisions and others of general application, the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection RESOLVES:

FIRST: TO UPHOLD the complaint filed by A.A.A. as it is considered that the provisions of Article 17 of the GDPR have been infringed and to urge AVALIS DE CATALUNYA, S.G.R., with NIF V63201032, to send to the claimant a certification within ten working days following the notification of this resolution, addressing the right of Erasure exercised or denying it with justification indicating the reasons why the request cannot be attended to, in accordance with what is established in the body of this resolution.

The actions taken as a consequence of this Resolution must be communicated to this Agency within the same period. Non-compliance with this resolution could result in the commission of an infringement of Article 83.6 of the GDPR, classified as very serious for the purposes of prescription in Article 72.1.m) of the LOPDGDD, which will be sanctioned in accordance with Article 58.2 of the GDPR.

SECOND: NOTIFY this resolution to A.A.A. and to AVALIS DE CATALUNYA, S.G.R.

In accordance with the provisions of Article 50 of the LOPDGDD, this Resolution will be made public once it has been notified to the interested parties.

Against this resolution, which concludes the administrative procedure (Article 18.4 of the LOPD), and in accordance with the provisions of Article 123 of Law 39/2015, of October 1, on the Common Administrative Procedure of Public Administrations, a voluntary appeal for reconsideration may be filed before the Director of the Spanish Agency for Data Protection, within one month from the day following the notification of this resolution, or a direct contentious-administrative appeal before the Contentious-Administrative Chamber of the National Court, in accordance with the provisions of Article 25 and in section 5 of the Fourth Additional Provision of Law 29/1998, of July 13, regulating Contentious-Administrative Jurisdiction, within two months from the day following the notification of this act, as provided in Article 46.1 of the aforementioned legal text.

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